



India's solar equipment imports and exports return to pre-Covid levels

Imports of solar cells and modules upped by a staggering 1,000% in the second quarter of 2021, totaling \$762 million (about ₹56.6 billion) as compared to \$69 million (about ₹5.25 billion) during the same period last year which was severely affected by Covid-19. Despite higher component costs and shortages, imports soared 346% in the first half of 2021 compared to the first half of 2020, while exports rose by 50% compared to the same period last year. However, compared to pre-pandemic activity in 2019, imports were slightly lower. Exports, on the other hand, were up by 30%.



PEOPLE (on the move)



Intel's Dr Randhir Thakur joins Tata Group



Tata Group now has Dr Randhir Thakur as a director. Dr Thakur was previously associated with Intel as chief supply chain officer. He has previously worked with the likes of Applied Materials, SanDisk, and Marvell Semiconductor. It is worth noting here that supply chain is said to be one of the important aspects of semiconductor business.

Tata's Chairman N. Chandrasekaran has recently noted that Tata Group is looking to make a foray into semiconductor manufacturing.

Mahindra Electric's CTO and CEO resign



Martin Murray has resigned from his responsibilities as chief technology officer (CTO) of Mahindra Electric Mobility. His last working day with Mahindra Electric was July 31, 2021. Mahesh Babu has also quit his association with Mahindra Electric in order to pursue

interests outside the company. He was serving as the CEO and MD of the company. Murray, based in Bengaluru, was reporting to Mahesh Babu.



Manish Sharma to become chairman of Panasonic India

Manish Sharma, at present president of Panasonic India, will take on the role of chairman starting October 2021. The company is making certain changes in its structure and

the move is part of the same. Known for his leadership skills, Sharma has been associated with Panasonic India since August 2008. He had joined the organisation in the capacity of marketing head for Panasonic's consumer electronics and home appliances vertical. Sharma also worked with Haier, Samsung, and LG Hotline in the past.



Intel appoints Christy Pambianchi as executive vice president and chief people officer

Intel Corporation has announced the appointment of Christy Pambianchi as executive vice president and chief people officer, effective 7th September. Pambianchi will lead human resources with a mandate to attract, engage, and retain the best talent as Intel strengthens execution and innovation to accelerate its transformation. She will report to CEO Pat Gelsinger.



First Solar appoints Anita Marangoly George to board of directors

First Solar has appointed Anita Marangoly George, a senior executive with almost four decades of diverse global experience in institutional finance and sustainable infrastructure investing, to its board of directors, effective July 15, 2021. She will serve on First Solar's Nominating and Governance, and Technology Committees.

